throat. It was about as large as the kabg-i-darī and seemed to be the kabg-i-darī of Hindustan.

Babur notes an interesting saying of people. He notes in Baburnama, ‘When the birds, at the onset of winter, descend to the hill-skirts if they come over a vineyard, they can fly no further and are taken.’

Babur talks about a kind of rat in Nijr-aū, known as the muskrat, which smelled of musk; Babur never saw it. Panjhīr (Panj-sher) was another tūmān; it lay close to Kāfiristān, along the Panjhīr road, and served as the thoroughfare of Kāfir highwaymen who, due to their proximity, also levied a tax on it. They had gone through it, causing a great loss of lives and committing many wicked deeds (in Babur’s eyes), since Babur came that last time and conquered Hindustan (AD 1526).

Another was the tūmān of Ghūr-bund. In those countries, a *kūtal* was referred to as a bund, and they journey towards Ghūr through this pass. Apparently, this is why they named the tūmān Ghūr-bund. The Hazāra inhabited the heads of its valleys. It had few villages, and little revenue could be collected from it. There were said to be mines of silver and lapis lazuli in its mountains.

Additionally, there were the villages located on the skirts of the Hindū-kush mountains, with Mīta-kacha and Parwān at their head, and Dūr-nāma at their foot, totalling 12 or 13 in all. These were fruit-bearing villages that produced delightful wines, with those from Khwāja Khāwand Sa‘īd being renowned for their strength in the vicinity. The villages all lay on the foothills, and while some paid taxes, not all were taxable because of their remote location in the mountains.

Between the foothills and the Bārān-water, there were two detached stretches of level land, one known as Kurrat-tāziyān, and the other as Dasht-i-shaikh (Shaikh’s plain). Because the green grass of the millet grew well there, they served as the gathering places for Turks and Moghūl clans (aīmāq).

Babur once observed that many-colored tulips adorned those foothills. He undertook a count and found that there were thirty-two or thirty-three different varieties. Among them, they (Babur and his men) gave a name to one: the Rose-scented tulip because its fragrance resembled that of the red rose. It grew exclusively on Shaikh’s plain, found nowhere else. Another unique variety was the Hundred-leaved tulip, growing by itself at the outlet of the Ghūr-bund narrows, on the hill-skirt below Parwān. A low hill, known as Khwāja Reg-i-rawān (Khwāja-of-the-running-sand), separated the two mentioned pieces of level land. This hill had a strip of sand from